That set a pattern that was to continue for two years. Fred was chronically hard up. One of the reasons was that he was paying new and struggling writers out of his own funds to keep them going, whenever he was certain their stories would eventually sell, or when their stories had sold but the buyers were slow in paying.

This meant, of course, that he had to hold off on the money of those who, like myself, could afford to wait. He was chronically in debt to me, therefore, from this point on, but I didn't worry. For one thing, I always knew exactly how much he owed me, and his payments, though late, did come. For another, I owed him so much in a non-financial way that I could scarcely complain.

4

On September 4, advance copies of Foundation arrived, and other things were moving, too. The textbook, for instance, was in its last stages, and soon we would have a completed manuscript

On September 21, Gotthard Guenther (who had once developed his odd theory of the significance of "Nightfall") called to tell me that

1 See Buy Jupiter and Other Stories.

his German publisher wanted to put out a German edition of J, Robot. This was eventually done. It appeared as lch y der Robot, and it was the first time anything I had written appeared in a foreign language (or at least it was the first foreign translation I saw).

5

The first problem with David, other than the day-to-day feeding, diapering, washing, and weighing, was the matter of circumcision.

Gertrude and I took it as a matter of course that there would be no religious ritual involved and we were certainly not going to try to have the ceremony performed on the traditional eighth day, when he was entirely too small and fragile.

On the other hand, I didn't want to let circumcision go altogether. It was a hygienic move, I believed (though I might have been the readier to believe it out of a lingering superstition), and I didn't want to seem to be denying that David was Jewish.